Unit 11A · In the museum

Speaking · 12 sets · for the teacher

How to use it. Pick a set, read the questions, point to the words. Let students answer in their own way: the green line is only a model. The first sets push today's grammar, the middle sets bring back older grammar, and the last sets are open and creative.

1 Our street long ago

IMAGINE

Push these words: **there was** · there were · horses · market

Imagine our street a hundred years ago. What was there?
→ There was a market and there were some horses.

What wasn't there?
→ There weren't any cars or buses.

Were there any shops?
→ Yes, there were. There were small shops.

Was it noisy?
→ No, it wasn't. It was quiet.

2 A town without cars

IMAGINE

Push these words: **cars** · horses · quiet · clean

How did people travel when there weren't any cars?
→ They traveled by horse and by train.

Was the air cleaner?
→ Yes, it was. There weren't any cars.

Were there any buses?
→ No, there weren't, but there were some trams.

Is it better now? Why?
→ It's faster now, but the air was cleaner then.

3 My school ten years ago

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **school** · playground · classroom · computer

Was there a playground at your school?
→ Yes, there was. There was a big one.

Were there any computers?
→ No, there weren't. There were only books.

What was there in the classroom?
→ There was a board and there were some desks.

What isn't there now?
→ There isn't an old fence now.

4 In the museum

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **museum** · old · picture · ship

What was there in the museum?
→ There were old ships and pictures.

Was there a plane?
→ Yes, there was. It was very old.

Were there any motorcycles?
→ No, there weren't.

What was the most interesting thing?
→ The most interesting thing was a small ship.

5 A strange town

IMAGINE

Push these words: **strange** · giant · tram · tunnel

Imagine a strange town. What was there?
→ There was a giant tram and there were green taxis.

Were there any people?
→ No, there weren't. There were only cats.

Was there a tunnel?
→ Yes, there was. It was very long.

Where was the tunnel?
→ It was under a mountain.

6 Holiday places

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **ferry** · airport · station · port

What was there at the airport?
→ There were many planes and a big café.

Was there a ferry on your last trip?
→ Yes, there was. It was big.

Were there any seagulls?
→ Yes, there were. There were a lot.

What wasn't there?
→ There wasn't a train.

7 Then and now

OPINION

Push these words: **then** · now · better · easier

What is different between then and now?
→ Now there are planes. Then there weren't any.

Is life easier now?
→ Yes, it is, because we have phones and cars.

What was better then?
→ There was less noise.

Would you like to live a hundred years ago?
→ No, I wouldn't. There weren't any computers.

8 A hundred years ago: questions

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **was there** · were there · yes · no

Was there a TV a hundred years ago?
→ No, there wasn't.

Were there any cinemas?
→ No, there weren't.

Was there a school?
→ Yes, there was.

Were there any books?
→ Yes, there were.

9 Places in town

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **between** · in the middle of · along · inside

What was in the middle of our town?
→ There was a square with a fountain.

What was between the school and the park?
→ There was a small street.

What was along the river?
→ There were big trees.

What was inside the old station?
→ There was a ticket office.

10 Past and present

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **is** · are · was · were · yesterday

Is there a park near your house? Was there one ten years ago?
→ Yes, there is. Yes, there was.

Are there any shops? Were there any before?
→ Yes, there are. Yes, there were.

Was the weather nice yesterday?
→ Yes, it was.

Are your friends here now? Were they here yesterday?
→ Yes, they are. No, they weren't.

11 The old film

IMAGINE

Push these words: **film** · black and white · old · actors

Imagine you watch an old film. What is there in it?
→ There are old cars and men in hats.

Were there any phones?
→ Yes, there were, but they were big.

Was there any color?
→ No, there wasn't. It was black and white.

Is it interesting?
→ Yes, it is.

12 A strange school

IMAGINE

Push these words: **strange** · giant · desk · tunnel

Imagine a strange school. What was there?
→ There was a giant desk and there were green chairs.

Was there a teacher?
→ Yes, there was. It was a friendly robot.

Were there any students?
→ Yes, there were. They were cats.

Was there a tunnel?
→ Yes, there was. It was long and dark.